Consular Army: The basic field force in the Republican era. There were two consuls for each year, and each was assigned an army that consisted of two legions (usually) and two corresponding alae. This legion-ala organization is usually called a "double legion". The modern equivalent would be a four-division corps, with a working strength of around 19,000 troops, led by a consul. Unfortunately, consul was a political office that required (at the time) little military skill, a fact often revealed on the battlefield. Although citizens-derived, the legion was a well-trained, professional force, as were the equivalent alae. The difference between success and failure often lay not in the troops and the manipular system, but in how they were used by their commanding consuls. The Roman armies did not come into their own until the military skills and insight of Scipio Africanus (Publius Cornelius Scipio) were brought to bear.